

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

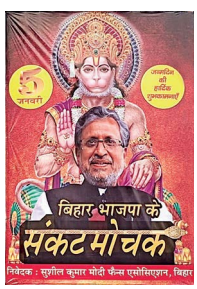
GLASSHOUSE

THE DEALBREAKERS

They may have gathered for seat-sharing talks, but there's little sharing of opinion between INDIA constituents, particularly the Congress and AAP, which rules Delhi and Punjab. Local Congress units in both states—which account for 20 LS seats—are unwilling to cede an inch to AAP, even though the latter has been a bit more gracious, offering the Grand Old Party nine seats. The cold war between Rahul Gandhi and AAP supremo and Delhi CM Arvind Kejriwal isn't helping either. Despite repeated requests, Kejriwal has yet to get an audience with Rahul. Kejriwal and West Bengal CM Mamata Banerjee's proposal that Mallikarjun Kharge be INDIA's PM candidate could only have been salt on Congress wounds. Then, there's the hostility between party treasurer and Rahul favourite Ajay Maken and Kejriwal. How does one make a deal?

Troubling Epithet

On January 5, when BJP Rajya Sabha MP **Sushil Modi** celebrated his 72nd birthday, a few of the posters that appeared across Patna, including one near the BJP office, had his picture with Lord Hanuman in the background. Modi was hailed as Bihar BJP *ke Sankatmochak* (troubleshooter). Though Modi played it down, saying every BJP worker was like Hanuman, his opponents in JD(U) are asking if BJPwallahs are foreseeing a big *sankat* (trouble) in election year.





ANI

Tech Rescue



Following a dialogue with home secretary **Ajay Bhalla,** truckers withdrew their nationwide strike over the proposed "hit and run" provisions in the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, but now the government is mulling how technology can help the latter report accidents. Ideas like a centralised number or an app for truckers to report accidents promptly have met with a positive response. It could enable truckers to notify authorities without having to stay at the accident site and risk public anger. Meanwhile, the new provision continues to rile truckers, who haven't stopped venting their anger on social media.

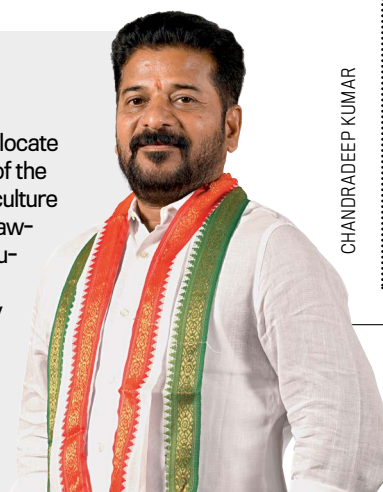


C.V. Versus the V-Cs

West Bengal governor **C.V. Ananda Bose's** move to appoint vice-chancellors in various universities without consulting the state government seems to be boomeranging on him. After handpicking Buddhadeb Sau as Jadavpur University V-C, the Raj Bhavan has now removed him, apparently because he sided with the state government. The latter, though, has asked Sau to stay. Other V-Cs Bose had appointed have also had to establish backchannel communications with the state government since it is virtually impossible to run an institution without its support. Wonder what their fate will be.

Relocation Challenge

Telangana chief minister **A. Revanth Reddy's** move to relocate the state high court in Hyderabad from the southern bank of the Musi to a 100-acre verdant patch to the west, abutting the agriculture university in Rajendranagar, has the state divided. Judges and lawyers welcome it, considering the congested commute to the courts. But others, including some lawyers, oppose the shift. Old city residents want to keep the only important public office they have. Meanwhile, green activists want 40 of the 100 acres, developed as an agro-biodiversity zone, preserved, and plan to challenge the decision in court. One tangled legal premise.



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

Kaushik Deka with Arkamoy Datta Majumdar, Avishek G. Dastidar, Amitabh Srivastava and Amarnath K. Menon